

AFTER

Scientists continue to dream of pushing back the realms of possibility in the 21st century.

SPACE EXPLORATION

The **space elevator** is a proposed structure that would consist of a cable anchored to Earth's surface and attached to a counterweight in space. Theoretically, vehicles could climb the cable and escape the planet's gravity without the use of rocket propulsion. Scientists are also pioneering the use of robots, such as the **Mars Exploration Rover**, to explore nearby planets.

MOVING MATTER

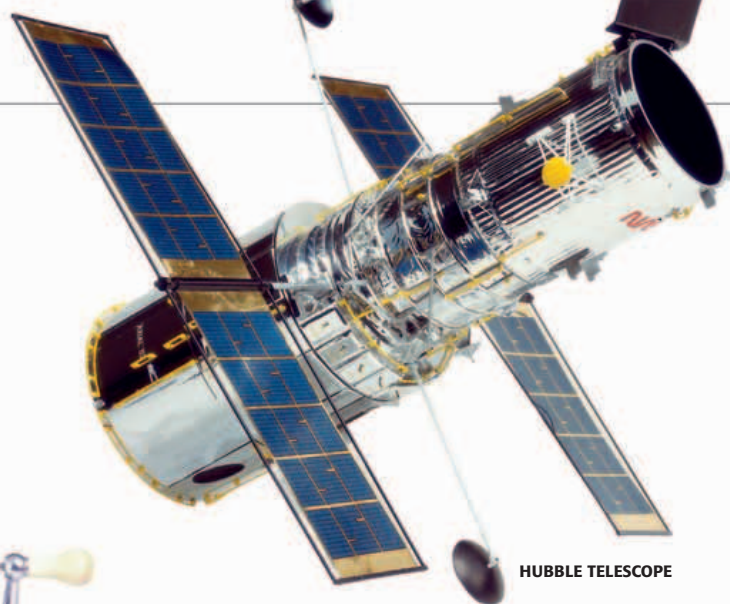
Scientists are also developing the process of **quantum tunneling** in the hope of achieving matter transportation.



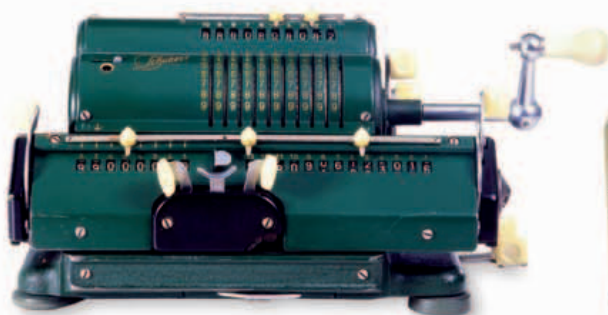
MARS EXPLORER



SOLAR PANELS



HUBBLE TELESCOPE



ADDING MACHINE, MANUFACTURED 1950S



PORTABLE TRANSISTOR RADIO



DVD

1969 The **Concorde** flies for the first time. The commercial supersonic airliner entered service in 1976 and set many speed records, including the circumnavigation of the world in 31 hours, 27 minutes and 49 seconds.

1977 The Commodore PET (personal electronic transactor) was one of the first consumer-level computers to be launched, and it revolutionized home computing.

1983 The first cellular phones were sold in the 1980s but were conceived in 1947. At that time the technology required was nonexistent. Newer "smartphones," such as the BlackBerry, have computerlike functions, including email access.

1990 The **Hubble space telescope** is launched into Earth orbit. It has confirmed theories about the birth of planets and produced images of galaxies at various stages of development.

2001 Apple produces the **iPod**, a portable digital audio player. iPods have developed the technical capability to incorporate video and cell-phone technology. The technology was developed further with Apple's iPhone in 2007 and the iPad in 2010.

1960

1970

1980

1990

2000

1967 The first **handheld electronic calculator** provided features of earlier adding machines in a smaller and more portable form.

1980 Philips develops fluorescent energy-saving light bulbs. Low-wattage bulbs use up to 80 percent less energy and last up to 10 times as long as traditional light bulbs.

1983 British inventor James Dyson builds a prototype **cyclone-action vacuum cleaner**, with no dust bag.

1991 Kodak produces the **digital camera system**, having developed solid-state image sensors that converted light into digital pictures.

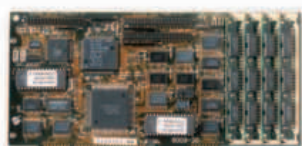
1995 The **DVD** (digitally versatile disc) is used for data storage, including high-quality sound and moving images.



ELECTRIC FOOD MIXER, MANUFACTURED 1950S



COMMODORE PET PERSONAL COMPUTER



COMPUTER MEMORY BOARD



DYSON VACUUM CLEANER



LOW-WATT LIGHT BULB



DIGITAL CAMERA



BLACKBERRY



APPLE IPOD



CONCORDE